both leading up to and after the peace agreement with Israel. The only explanation, I believe, for the thirty-year-plus relationship between Israel and Jordan is the late king's view that relations with Israel were valuable and essential for the survival of the kingdom. If anyone needed proof of this thesis, I would refer them to the events of "Black September" in Jordan in 1970, when, in response to the Jordanian massacre of Fatah, the Syrians sent a military force southward toward Jordan, and only the deployment of Israeli forces in the southern Golan Heights convinced the Syrians to abandon their military advancement and withdraw their forces.

These considerations also influenced King Hussein's strategy in everything related to the march toward peace, throughout that entire period and during the years of negotiations. There was a radical difference between the king's strategy and that of Israel. As mentioned earlier, the king adopted a step-by-step approach. He tried to persuade his Israeli interlocutors to "focus on small agreements; we'll accumulate one agreement after another, and when we reach a decisive amount of small but important agreements, we will wrap it all up in the package of a peace agreement." This approach of the king was based, in my estimation, on his belief that the Arab world would tolerate small, measured moves toward peace but would not accept a single major comprehensive move that resulted in a full peace agreement.

Israel's approach was always the opposite: to do everything quickly and in one shot, and to know that the deed was done. Negotiations for peace, therefore, carried on for many years, moving constantly between these poles—the willingness to go in the direction of small agreements and the desire to achieve one big agreement.

Another reason on the Israeli side for difficulties and for the prolongation of the negotiations was the different agendas and preferences of the various parties involved in the process, with each pulling in a different direction. These bodies included the intelligence community, the foreign ministry, the Shin Bet, and others. The different preferences stemmed not only from different interests but from varying assessments; there were those who maintained that the Syrian track should be the first focus, those who preferred to begin with the Jordanian track, and those who argued that the Palestinian track should take priority. Over the years, the entire process was conducted according to an agenda that was dictated by the United States, which did not always coincide with the agenda of Israel